

80 GB hard disks are de facto today; but what do you do with all that space? Here are some suggestions...

Optimise Your



Program Files - 3 GB

You can move the Program Files directory to another partition. All it takes is a registry edit as soon as you finish installing Windows XP. Go to **Start > Run**, type 'regedit' and head to: **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\Current Version** and change the **KEY = ProgramFilesDir** to reflect the new partition; for example **D:\Program Files**. Do not delete **C:\Program Files**! This is a sentimental place for Windows XP, the OS needs it...



My Documents - 3 GB

The My Documents folder carries much more than your documents. It is where movies and music are meant to be stored by default (which we won't do). Moreover, files that you receive over an Instant Messenger such as MSN Messenger or Yahoo! Messenger also reside here. So do e-books created by Adobe Acrobat, etc



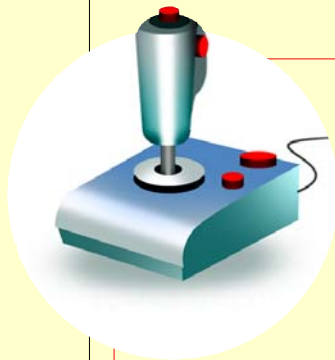
Windows XP - 7 GB

Reinstalling an operating system becomes easier once you have segregated it from your data files. No more backing up to another hard disk. Just delete the OS partition and reinstall



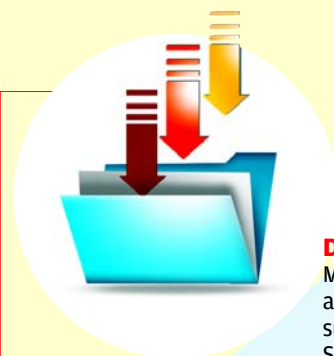
Temp - 500 MB

This is a dedicated partition for your Windows' swap. To be more effective, change the default cluster size of this one to 64 KB. Note that this is not an essential element by far



Games - 9.5 GB

With games breaking the 3-CD barrier, more space is always welcome. You can also store patches and mods for your favourite games in here



Downloads - 6 GB

Make this the default partition to which a download manager (such as FlashGet, supplied on the Digit DVD) saves files to. Similarly, this can be the default path that browsers such as Opera or Firefox use to save files

